

**CONWAY CITY COUNCIL BUDGET RETREAT
OFFICE OF MCMILLAN PAZDAN SMITH ARCHITECTURE, SPARTANBURG, SC
MARCH 5-6, 2026**

THURSDAY, MARCH 5, 2026 – 8:00 A.M.

PRESENT: Mayor Barbara Jo Blain, Mayor Pro Tem Beth Helms, Amanda Butler, William Goldfinch, Julie Hardwick, Justin Jordan, Larry White

STAFF: Adam Emrick, City Administrator; Mary Catherine Hyman, Deputy City Administrator; John Rogers, Deputy City Administrator; Allison Williams, Finance Director; June Wood, Public Information Officer; and Alicia Shelley, City Clerk

CALL TO ORDER: Mayor Blain called the meeting to order.

The following items were discussed during the first day of Council's annual Budget Retreat:

General Fund Budget:

- City Council
- Human Resources
- Administration
- Planning & Development
- Technology Services
- Finance
- Police
- Court
- Fire
- Construction Services
- Public Works
- Vehicle Maintenance
- Hospitality & Beautification

Motion: Jordan made a motion, seconded by Blain, to go into Executive Session for the following: (A) Discussion regarding Potential Acquisition of Property on Sherwood [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]; and (B) Discussion of potential contractual agreement regarding City lease of property [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried. White recused himself.

Motion: Hardwick made a motion, seconded by Blain to come out of executive session. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

No vote was taken, no actions were taken.

General Fund Budget discussion continued:

- Solid Waste
- Recreation

The following Budget review items were discussed:

- Street & Drainage Fund Budget
- Stormwater Fund Budget
- Public Utilities Fund Budget

Motion: Helms made a motion, seconded by Jordan, to go into Executive Session for the following: Update on Contractual Matter. [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]; **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms to come out of executive session. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

No vote was taken, no actions were taken.

Council members recessed the meeting until 8:00 a.m. on Friday, March 6, 2026.

FRIDAY, MARCH 6, 2026 – 8:00 A.M.

PRESENT: Mayor Barbara Jo Blain, Mayor Pro Tem Beth Helms, Amanda Butler, William Goldfinch, Julie Hardwick, Justin Jordan, Larry White

STAFF: Adam Emrick, City Administrator; Mary Catherine Hyman, Deputy City Administrator; John Rogers, Deputy City Administrator; Allison Williams, Finance Director; June Wood, Public Information Officer; and Alicia Shelley, City Clerk

The Retreat continued at 8:00 a.m.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Butler, to go into Executive Session for the following: (A) Discussion of an Economic Development Opportunity in the Mill Pond Road area [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (5)]; (B) Discussion of an Economic Development Opportunity in the Marina Drive Area [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (5)]; (C) Discussion of an Economic Development Opportunity in the Central Business District [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (5)]; (D) Discussion of negotiations to proposed contractual arrangements in the Highway 378 area [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]; (E) Discussion of negotiations incident to ongoing legal matters related to underground utility conversion [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

Motion: Goldfinch made a motion, seconded by Blain to come out of executive session. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

No vote was taken, no actions were taken.

Budget Review continued:

- Accommodations Tax Fund Budget
- Hospitality Tax Fund Budget

The Planning Discussion for FY 2026-2027 began.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Butler, to go into Executive Session for the following: Discussion of negotiations to potential contractual matters [pursuant to SC Code §30-4-70 (A) (2)]; **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

Motion: Jordan made a motion, seconded by Hardwick to come out of executive session. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

No vote was taken, no actions were taken.

Motion: Blain made a motion, seconded by Helms to adjourn the Budget Retreat. **Vote:** Unanimous. Motion carried.

APPROVAL OF MINUTES: Minutes approved by City Council this 16 day of March, 2026.



Alicia Shelley, City Clerk